

Chapter 139_2 - Infinite

One day when she woke up, the disheveled remnants from yesterday still lay beneath her. Ning Fuyi's face was slightly red as she slowly got up. The intoxicating fragrance of flowers still lingered in the air, but the person was nowhere to be seen.

Ning Fuyi slowly tidied up the bedchamber. Only after all traces of last night's abandon were gone did she put on her clothes and go outside.

Just then, Chu Qingqiu was returning from the cliff's edge, her eyes seeming to carry some worries. But upon seeing Ning Fuyi, she smiled: "Yiyi, you're awake?"

"I'm awake," Ning Fuyi smiled, wrapping her arms around Chu Qingqiu's waist and nestling against her shoulder affectionately. "What were you doing at the cliff's edge?"

Chu Qingqiu paused briefly, then said, "Elder Pingyao came to find me to discuss some sect matters."

Ning Fuyi nodded without asking further questions and lifted her head, seeking a kiss.

Chu Qingqiu smiled lightly, lowering her head to peck her lips once, then straightened up seriously: "Alright, go cultivate."

"As you command," Ning Fuyi said with a radiant smile as she got up from her.

After Chu Qingqiu left, Ning Fuyi followed her footsteps to the cliff's edge. Just as she was about to sit cross-legged, she inadvertently noticed something black on the grass tips. Her heart stirred, and she touched it with her fingertip.

Horror surged through her heart like a tide.

How could ordinary flames burn thousand-year-old Cold Iron to this state? Her expression grew cold as she turned her palm and summoned a translucent formation array. Within the array were wavy patterns—it was a voice transmission array.

"Han Ya, come here," she said.

In less than half an incense stick's time, a pitch-black crow shot toward the barrier like an arrow released from a bow. Ning Fuyi quickly waved her hand to tear open the barrier, watching the crow limp in and transform into human form.

"Ow, that hurt..." Han Ya chattered, but after Ning Fuyi glanced at her, she puffed out her cheeks and straightened up: "Demon Lord."

This was how they addressed her when no one else was around.

"Have there been any unusual activities in the outside world recently?" Ning Fuyi asked.

"The demon realm is as usual, nothing unusual," Han Ya said, stroking her chin thoughtfully. "But the immortal sects are in some chaos. I heard from people at the Deterrent Hall that there seems to be a mountain fire in the Eastern Wilderness that directly burned down the Eastern Wilderness Konghou¹, causing all the fallen demons and monsters from that place of exile to pour into the mortal realm and wreak havoc."

"The Eastern Wilderness Konghou is an ancient divine artifact. What kind of fire could burn and destroy an ancient divine artifact?" Ning Fuyi frowned.

"No one knows about that. Anyway, people from the immortal sects have already gone to the Eastern Wilderness. They say the mountain fire can't be extinguished, so they can only move mountains to prevent it from spreading to other realms."

An inextinguishable mountain fire. Ning Fuyi lowered her brows.

Infinite Ghost Fire.

A wave of anger and powerlessness enveloped her. Ning Fuyi's legs felt weak, and she covered her face with her hands. Even though they had worked so hard to extinguish the fire seed, it was all in vain now.

So Chu Qingqiu's abnormal behavior was because she knew about this matter. Being such a sincere person, she would never abandon the common people.

And her current cautiousness was just because she was afraid of disappointing herself, so she was struggling.

"I understand," Ning Fuyi said. "You may go."

That night they still embraced and slept as usual, but when Ning Fuyi woke up again, the space beside her was already cold, the person having left at some unknown time.

She stared at the bed curtains above with open eyes for a long while, then turned over and got up, tidied the bed, and went out to cultivate.

Cool breezes blew at the cliff's edge. Her immortal energy was often unstable, and when she finally couldn't continue, she stopped cultivating and began reading through the Divine-Demon Manual that Chu Qingqiu had transcribed, marking several forbidden techniques related to demonic energy.

It wasn't until sunset and moonrise, when the night grew deep and dew heavy, that the barrier behind her stirred. Ning Fuyi stood up and met the gaze of Chu Qingqiu, whose steps were unsteady.

Chu Qingqiu was obviously somewhat flustered. She wrapped her moon-white cloak tightly around herself and opened her mouth to say something, but Ning Fuyi walked up to her in a few steps and forcefully opened the cloak.

Hideous wounds immediately appeared before her eyes. Although they were covered by clothing, several scars were still visible. The edges of the scars were smooth and red—clearly burn injuries.

"Yiyi, listen to me..." Chu Qingqiu tried to grab her sleeve, but the sleeve was immediately pulled from her palm, and the woman ran away in big strides, disappearing from sight.

"Ning Fuyi!" Chu Qingqiu called out sternly, but when she turned, the movement pulled at the wound on her leg, and the pain cut off her words abruptly. She bit her teeth for a long time before enduring it, then bent over dejectedly.

Panic almost overflowed from her eyes.

Ning Fuyi was angry in her heart, but she wasn't sulking. She roughly rummaged through the stone hall and found the medicine box that Jiang Li had left behind. She had been afraid Chu Qingqiu would use it, so she hadn't put it in the One Thought Pearl, but now it came in handy.

Though the medicine box was small, it had hidden compartments containing thousands of layers. Ning Fuyi frantically searched through it for a while before finally extracting cooling ointment from the smallest compartment, then flashed out of the hall.

Chu Qingqiu was nowhere to be seen. She had to release her divine consciousness to find her, then flashed over again. This delayed her somewhat, and when she finally reached the bottom of the mountain cliff, she saw Chu Qingqiu standing alone with her back to her.

Her waist wasn't as straight as usual, as if invisible burdens weighed on her back.

"Chu Qingqiu, you..." Ning Fuyi's words stopped abruptly when she ran to her front and saw her tear-filled eyes in a daze.

Chu Qingqiu shifted her body slightly, not letting Ning Fuyi stare at her face.

"I never intended to hide it from you. It's just that the situation was urgent, and I'm still the Sect Leader of Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate—I had to go," she said in a low voice. "A great fire broke out in the Eastern Wilderness. It's Infinite Ghost Fire."

"I know you don't want to risk your life again. I understand you—this shouldn't have fallen on you in the first place. But I'm still the Divine Venerable, so I must be responsible for all living beings under heaven."

"You're angry. I had promised to stay with you, so your frustration is justified," Chu Qingqiu's voice was flat. "I'm sorry."

Her tone had no fluctuation, but with tears added, the contrast made her no longer seem rigid, instead making Ning Fuyi feel somewhat at a loss.

Ning Fuyi lowered her phoenix eyes, then raised them again, smiling at the corners. She opened Chu Qingqiu's cloak and used immortal energy to spread the ointment evenly over her exposed wounds, watching those lotus-like arms contract slightly from pain.

Under the sleeves were large areas of burns, shocking to behold.

"I am indeed frustrated, but not because you went to help, but because you got injured," Ning Fuyi said, lowering her head to cast the spell, making the ointment work evenly.

Chu Qingqiu looked at her through her tears. The woman's face indeed showed no anger, nor any hostility or extremism—only mature tranquility.

Chu Qingqiu suddenly felt somewhat dazed. Only now did she realize that the little demon who used to fly into uncontrollable rage in her memories had, after experiencing so much, completely changed from her former self.

"I never used to block your path, and I won't now either," Ning Fuyi raised her eyes with a smile, coaxing gently, "I'll accompany you, alright?"

¹ Eastern Wilderness Konghou (东荒箜篌): Konghou is an ancient Chinese harp-like musical instrument. Here it refers to a divine artifact named after this instrument.